

Niharika Dalal

Product Designer | B2B Enterprise SaaS, Fintech and Insurance

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Summary

Product Designer with 5+ years leading design in fast-paced, multi-project environments, grounded in a software engineering background. Adept at translating ambiguous, complex problems into simplified and scalable systems, rapidly mastering industry contexts, and managing context-switching across asynchronous priorities. Delivered a 60% lift in university admin productivity, and spearheaded a design strategy that secured a \$600M insurance contract. Leverages systems thinking and end-to-end delivery expertise to drive user-centric growth, eliminate user friction, and deliver high-impact business outcomes.

Work Experience

UX Designer | EXL

2021 - 2026

Dual-Audience Experience Restructuring

- Spearheaded the design strategy for a winning RFP proof-of-concept, **securing a contract with a \$600M insurance provider** and directly impacting the user experience for **250K+ monthly users**.
- Aligned executive leadership behind a high-contrast visual standard (leveraged UX Pilot AI to accelerate designs) that lifted **desktop performance by +37%**, **web best practices by +28%**, and achieved **100% accessibility compliance**.
- Re-architected the core website information architecture end-to-end, for homeowners and independent agents, with a symmetric navigation model that surfaced critical self-service paths, while **reducing long-term CMS maintenance**.

Exposure Tool Architecture Centralization

- Directed end-to-end UX discovery and delivery across a **4-week engagement, without direct access to end users**, producing validated design concepts to inform the product roadmap and enable the team to proceed with confidence.
- Restructured the fragmented information architecture of a critical risk validation tool by collapsing 3 redundant data views into a unified master-detail framework, **eliminating cognitive re-mapping** across disparate data models.
- **Eliminated dual-save ambiguity** and stacked-row cognitive friction across complex financial datasets by designing a unified high-density table framework and a session-commit model.

Loan App Experience Optimization

- Streamlined the loan application mobile app for **16M+ customers in 4 weeks** by **reducing friction 36%**, optimizing the primary digital channel for pre-approved customers: 80% of digital installment loan volume.
- **Reduced interaction cost, improved funnel conversion** and elevated visual craft by applying behavioral design principles: replacing multi-tap dropdowns with dynamic sliders for real-time rate updates.
- **Sustained user momentum** and **reduced abandonment risk** by introducing progress indicators and milestone illustrations at 3 key completion points throughout the application flow.

Centralizing Enterprise CSR Reporting and Analytics

- Spearheaded the end-to-end design strategy to consolidate cross-departmental data workflows into a **centralized platform architecture**, translating siloed operational pain points into a unified information hierarchy and comprehensive user flows to **establish organization-wide impact visibility**.
- Modularized enterprise tracking mechanisms by designing a scalable, customizable dashboard framework for **real-time KPI and budget tracking**, integrated with a multi-variable data visualization tool that enabled executive filtering across regions to **accelerate strategic decision-making**.
- Championed collaborative prototype testing and feedback sessions with departmental leaders to **de-risk feature usability** and aligning cross-functional requirements with engineering feasibility to drive execution.

Admissions Process Acceleration

- **Boosted admissions counselor productivity by 60%** (from 16 to 25 applications daily) by designing an automated transfer credit evaluation system with a rules engine **eliminating manual cross-referencing and reducing error**.
- **Simplified evaluation workflow** by architecting a platform that automatically mapped transfer credits to coursework, allowing counselors to focus on exceptions requiring expert review rather than repetitive manual tasks.

Accelerating Targeted Lead Generation

- Transformed complex lead-generation workflows for an enterprise marketing campaign tool into a 5-step guided segmentation engine, **resolving cognitive overload** and **unblocking multi-channel deployment for marketers**.
- Integrated dynamic data visualizations and real-time calculation feedback loops into the workflow, enabling users to instantly evaluate population changes and **define target segments with high confidence**.
- Drove discovery-to-delivery strategy, leveraging AI-driven research in Copilot to translate multi-layered filtering criteria into high-confidence publishing workflows that **eliminated user friction and elevated brand trust**.

Untethering Diners From Peak Restaurant Lines (personal project)

- Formulated a dual-stream access framework bifurcating restaurant throughput into a 30% advance-reservation model and a 70% geofenced virtual queue, utilizing Google Gemini to pressure-test service logic and **eliminate a critical check-in bypass bug to untether foot traffic from 2+ hour physical wait lines**.
- Engineered a commitment-queuing interaction model using Figma AI to implement transparent order-lock thresholds and QR arrival triggers that **prevent ghost queue entries while eliminating premature kitchen waste**.
- Accelerated cross-functional validation from problem discovery to a **functional React Native prototype** in 2 weeks, translating high-fidelity mockups into working code using Google Antigravity.

Front-end Developer | EXL 2020 - 2021

Transaction Ledger Centralization

- **Improved data-entry accuracy** and enabled **real-time transaction visibility** by building a React ledger application; translated mockups into production UI while reducing defects through proactive engineering and QA collaboration.

Skills

- **Design:** Product Design, UX/UI, Interaction Design, User Research, Design Systems (Style Guides, Components), Information Architecture, Data Visualization, Usability Testing, Prototyping, User Flows, Wireframing, Visual Design.
- **AI Tools:** Gemini, ChatGPT, Claude, UX Pilot, Open Design, Google Antigravity.
- **Toolkit:** Figma, FigJam, Photoshop, JIRA, ReactJS, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Drupal.
- **Methods & Process:** User-Centered Design, Agile/SCRUM, Persona Development, User Journey Mapping, Analytical Problem Solving, Cross-functional & Cross-cultural Collaboration.

Education & Certification

Google UX Design Certification, Coursera	2021
Rochester Institute of Technology, MS in Software Engineering	2020
Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies (NMIMS), BTech in Computer Engineering	2017